

PLSC 197 / SODA 110N: Social Data, Technology, and Artificial Intelligence

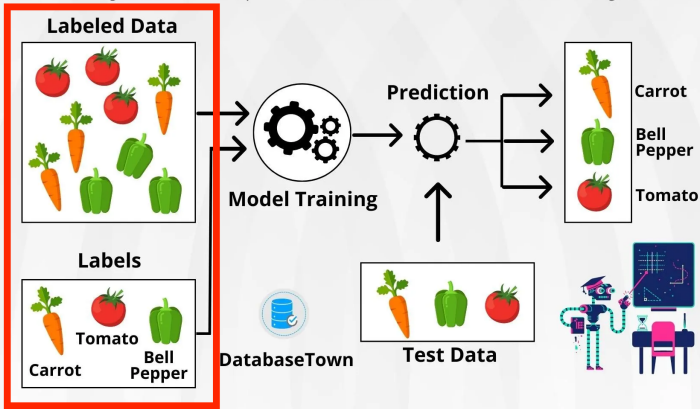
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Humans In The Pipeline (Part I)

SUPERVISED LEARNING

Supervised machine learning is a branch of artificial intelligence that focuses on training models to make predictions or decisions based on labeled training data.



The Importance of Labelling



Humans In The Pipeline: Dzieza (2023)

“Human intelligence is the basis of artificial intelligence” :

- $\exists$ millions of *people* who make the systems work
“...if you pull back the curtain even a little, it looks more familiar, the latest iteration of a particularly Silicon Valley division of labor, in which the futuristic gleam of new technologies hides a sprawling manufacturing apparatus and the people who make it run.”
- “Taskers”: Labelling, annotation, rating, conversation
- **RLHF** (reinforcement learning with human feedback):
 - AI does a task; humans rate it; the rating is used to train another AI to mimic human ratings
 - Gives the illusion of intelligence; goal = remove humans entirely

Implications (Dzieza 2023)

Matters because...:

- Secrecy → division of labor → opacity for workers + the public
- Opacity → exploitation...
 - Precarity
 - Cognitive complexity (“think like a robot”)
 - Wage arbitrage (e.g., Kenya → Nepal → India)
- Lack of “ground truth” → fundamental uncertainty → difficulty maintaining quality control
- Workers using AI assists...

Part II: Gray and Suri's "Ghost Work"

"Automation's Last Mile":

- Tasks: image labeling, content flagging, data cleaning, identity verification, transcription, surveys...
- Who does it, and why?
- What's it like? Isolation, algorithms, and precarity.
- Why "ghost"?
- What (if anything) to do?

Roberts: “Behind The Screen”

“Commercial content moderation” (CCM):

- Drives every platform (YouTube, Facebook/Instagram, TikTok, etc.)
- Massive scale
- Moderators:
 - Wide variation
 - A form of “ghost work,” plus
 - Added psychological stress
- Recommendations...

